the BRICS meets at a time of significant changes and pandemics unseen in a century. The BRICS group should create opportunities during this crisis and secure new prospects. The BRICS countries should work together to enhance BRICS credentials further to project it as a responsible global player in global solidarity to address the global governance deficit and contribute to the BRICS share to tackling common challenges.[27] However, things got changed a lot now. The impact and the fortunes of the BRICS individually and collectively have not lived up to the expectations. It is not the low level of economic growth or other reasons. But, the matter is that there is a gap in the BRICS group unity. Collective solidarity is sometimes not openly visible (Zeng and Beeson 2018). Therefore, unless or until China does not include other members of the BRICS, other members may feel alienated. So China has the responsibility to convince other members that China is extending the support to Global South countries to come out of the crisis rather than projecting itself as the big brother of the Global South and it can bully them. Then, how will China deal with the BRICS in the emerging global order?

The Future Role of China in the BRICS

Scholars like Shield (2014)[28] say that in the foreseeable future, what will drive China's international behavior will be its domestic development, its pursuit of social stability, its issues of global and economic governance, and its domestic prioritization. For that to happen, the BRICS platform should be better than any other because China and other remaining members have a common goal and intention. A specific group of Western scholars considers BRICS a failed experiment of the southern world countries. While BRICS has been facing some difficulties, BRICS has performed well and has contributed 50 percent to global growth over the last decade. Trade between the BRICS group crossed over 350 billion dollars in 2013. It makes up half of the world's total, so statements like those may also be understood as being made by those who consider BRICS as a threat to their dominance in global affairs. During the Ufa summit, Xi Jinping assertively said: ‘The more difficulties we face, the more confidence we have,’ and that we have to fathom that the growth path is not a straight line but a series of twists and turns (Wang 2015).[29]

During the Ufa summit in 2015, on July 9, Chinese President Xi Jinping stated that BRICS should work together for further cooperation and